

the filters, like writing a commonly filtered word like 'Sex' as 'S E X', 'S*E*X' or even '5 E ><'.

The most effective way to avoid unsolicited mail is by using good anti-spam software. Packages such as E-mailProtect (see chapter 5.2) for example, are capable of dynamic, real-time filtering of inbound e-mail, based on approved word and e-mail address lists. It sends all unsolicited and potentially dangerous e-mail to a quarantine folder where you can disable various aspects of the mail in order to preview it safely. Anti-spam software have intelligent engines that have an excellent ability to sort the spam from useful mail, which is perfect for someone who's mailbox is generally flooded with junk. You can easily setup whitelists and blacklists to help the anti-spam utilities identify a useful mail that may come across as spam. The only drawback is that most anti-spam software work only with e-mail clients, so if you're using a Web-based mail facility, an anti-spam application will not be much help.

Privacy Protection

A lot of Internet users don't realise that what they do online can be easily traced back to them. In fact, if you just monitor an Internet user's activity for a period of time, you can tell what's happening in his life. It's a scary thought that if someone takes enough initiative, all your information can be easily accessible like an open book.

To access most services on the Internet, we need to give out some accurate private information, such as our addresses, what we do, how much we earn and even our credit card numbers. Though most Web sites are quite secure with this information, chances are, there are cookies left behind on your machine that store everything you've written. Your browser history stores information about every page you surfed, and some of the pictures that you accessed on the Net can be found in your temporary Internet files.

We don't intend to make you paranoid about technology or the Internet, in fact most home users are not really under much threat at all; but a corporation with many rivals in the same business needs to be careful about the kind of traces it leaves behind.